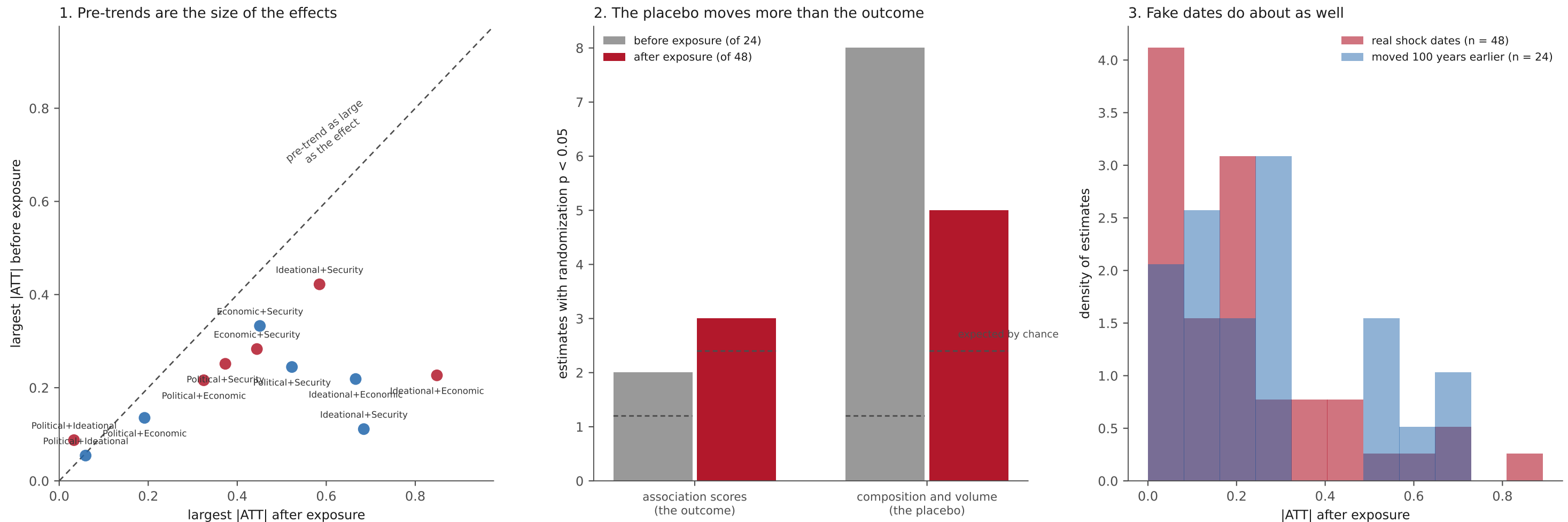


Three tests, and the design fails two of them



Left: for eleven of the twelve shock-type by crossing combinations the largest pre-exposure estimate is more than a sixth of the largest post-exposure one, and for one it is larger. Parallel trends is not a close call here. Middle: running the identical estimator on the share of elites in each domain, the crossing rate and the log number of recorded elites returns more results at $p < 0.05$ than the association scores do, and the strongest of them are before exposure. Whatever the shock countries are doing differently, they were doing it first, and it shows up in who gets recorded. Right: the estimator itself is not manufacturing effects, since fake dates produce a similar spread and nothing significant. The problem is the design, not the arithmetic. Source: BHHT cross-verified database of notable people (Laouenan et al., Scientific Data 9:290, 2022). Shocks hand-coded, see [data/processed/shocks/shock_list.csv](#).